

Word Stress

Word stress can be defined as the relative loudness in pitch and length associated with the pronunciation of a particular syllable in a word. A stressed syllable is a syllable that is louder, longer and higher in pitch than the other syllables in a word. What is a syllable? A syllable is a unit of human speech that can be interpreted as a single sound and is often produced with one puff of breath.

Examples of words of three syllables stressed on the first syllable

- Policy
- Delicate
- FORTunate
- Secondary
- CANDidate
- QUANtity
- ADvertise

Examples of words of three syllables stressed on the second syllable

1. coMEDian
2. emPHAtic
3. aDDItion
4. draMATic
5. tuTORial
6. poSItion
7. aTTENtion
8. toMORrow
9. deMONic
10. adVIsor
11. roTAtion
12. deCIision

Stress can also be the emphasis in the production or pronunciation of a particular syllable that are louder or longer than other syllables in a word. It is often marked by the use of capitalisation as expressed above.

The syllables without stress are called unstressed syllable and they do not affect one syllable words (mono syllabic)